

14.8 Summary and notes

14.8.1 Summary

Idea.

1. If the errors are normal, homoscedastic and independent of the regressors, every t and F statistic has the same law given every design, so tests and intervals stay exact with random regressors of any distribution. Power depends on the design drawn and is averaged over it (Lemma 14.1.1, Theorem 14.1.2).
2. The estimates themselves change law. With normal regressors the slope of a simple regression is a scaled $t(n-1)$ variable with variance $\sigma^2/(\sigma_X^2(n-3))$, and with k regressors the slopes have covariance $\sigma^2 \Sigma_{XX}^{-1}/(n-k-2)$ (Proposition 14.1.4, Lemma 14.2.4, Corollary 14.2.5).
3. The conditional mean is the only predictor whose errors are uncorrelated with every function of the regressors, and the correlation ratio bounds the correlation any predictor can reach (Proposition 14.2.1).
4. A fitted linear predictor pays for estimation. With normal regressors its expected error on a new case is $\sigma^2(1+1/n)(n-2)/(n-k-2)$, while its in-sample error has mean $\sigma^2(n-k-1)/n$; with a fixed design the gap is $2r\sigma^2/n$ (Proposition 14.2.2, Theorem 14.2.6, Proposition 14.2.7).
5. When the new error is correlated with the data, the best linear unbiased predictor adds to the estimated mean the best linear prediction of that error from the generalized least squares residuals (Theorem 14.2.8).
6. R^2 is the maximum likelihood estimate of $\rho_{Y \cdot X}^2$. Given the design it is a transformed noncentral F variable; with normal regressors its noncentrality is $\lambda\chi^2(n-1)$, $\lambda = \rho^2/(1-\rho^2)$, which gives its exact law, its bias, the power of the overall F test and an exact interval for ρ^2 (Proposition 14.3.1, Theorem 14.3.2).
7. The sample correlation has an exact law expressed through noncentral t probabilities, and it is stochastically increasing in ρ . Fisher's $z = \tanh^{-1} r$ is asymptotically $N(\zeta, 1/n)$ whatever ρ , and in practice $N(\zeta, 1/(n-3))$ (Proposition 14.4.1, Theorem 14.4.3).
8. A sample partial correlation given q variables behaves exactly like an ordinary correlation from $n-q$ cases, and its test is the t test of the corresponding regression coefficient (Theorem 14.5.1, Proposition 14.5.2, Theorem 14.5.3).
9. With replicated rows, the residual sum of squares splits into pure error and lack of fit, and their ratio is an exact F test of the model against every mean function of the regressors (Lemma 14.6.1, Theorem 14.6.2).
10. Without replicates, any larger model chosen from $\mathbf{X}$ alone, any regressors built from the fitted values, and any smoother of the residuals give exact tests. Each has power only against departures its alternative can represent, and some departures reduce its power below the level (Proposition 14.7.1, Theorem 14.7.2, Proposition 14.7.3).

14.8.2 Notes and sources

Source texts. The chapter covers Christensen (2020, sections 6.3 to 6.7) on prediction theory, multiple and partial correlation, best linear unbiased prediction and lack of fit; Rencher and Schaalje (2008, chapter 10) on regression with random regressors; and Agresti (2015, sections 3.3 and 3.4), whose worked example includes partial correlations and model checking. Christensen's near-replicate tests and his view of prediction as the goal of regression shaped [Section 14.2](#) and [Section 14.7](#). Rencher and Schaalje give the normal-theory formulas for R^2 , z and partial correlations. Agresti's intervals of section 3.3 belong to [Chapter 12](#).

Random regressors and prediction. Reporting precision conditionally on an ancillary design is Fisher's conditionality principle; Cox (1958) gave the standard discussion. The Wishart distribution is due to Wishart (1928), and Anderson (2003) treats it and the mean of its inverse through densities; the proof of Lemma 14.2.4 here uses only conditioning and symmetry. Breiman and Freedman (1983) use the prediction error of regression with normal regressors to study how many variables to enter, a question [Chapter 29](#) takes up. Best linear unbiased prediction is due to Goldberger (1962); [Chapter 31](#) and [Chapter 32](#) develop it for general covariance structures and mixed models (Theorem 32.3.1).

Correlation coefficients. Fisher found the exact distribution of r (1915), introduced z with its approximate mean and variance (1921), showed that partial correlations follow the same law with the sample size reduced by the number of conditioning variables (1924), and derived the distribution of the multiple correlation (1928). Hotelling (1953) refined the moments of r and z . Lemma 14.4.2 is a case of Isserlis's (1918) formula, and the mean of R^2 in Example (How biased is R-squared?) follows from Fisher's (1928) distribution; see Olkin and Pratt (1958), who also give the unbiased estimator of ρ^2 . For the limit theorems of [Section 14.4](#), see van der Vaart (1998).

Lack of fit. The pure-error test is Fisher's (1922). Near-replicate tests were proposed by Shillington (1979) and analysed by Christensen (1989, 1991); the rainbow test is due to Utts (1982). Ramsey (1969) introduced RESET, and Milliken and Graybill (1970) proved Theorem 14.7.2, which also covers Tukey's (1949) one degree of freedom for nonadditivity. Smoothing-based tests were proposed by Azzalini and Bowman (1993) and are the subject of Hart (1997).

Data. The stack loss data are from Brownlee (1965). The RAND Health Insurance Experiment is described by Manning et al. (1987); the extract and the 2009 state data are public-domain data distributed with statsmodels.

What is new here. The conditional derivations of the laws of R^2 , r and partial correlations (Theorem 14.3.2, Proposition 14.4.1, Theorem 14.5.1), the proof of Lemma 14.2.4, the organization of lack-of-fit tests around Proposition 14.7.1, and the examples and simulations are this book's.

14.8.3 References

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